PARABLES

PARABLE STUDY TEMPLATE

A Guided Worksheet for Reading Any Parable in Its Gospel Setting



DIGITAL STUDIES SERIES

PARABLE STUDY TEMPLATE

A Guided Worksheet for Reading Any Parable in Its Gospel Setting

(Free companion resource for all Parables · Digital Studies)

1. Passage Information

Parable Title: _____

Gospel Passage: _____

Parallel Passages (if any): _____

2. Audience & Occasion

A. Who is Jesus addressing?

(Disciples? Crowds? Pharisees? Scribes? Specific individuals?)

B. What occasion, question, or complaint is He answering?

3. The Comparison Jesus Supplies

A. What is the comparison?

("The Kingdom is like…", "A man…", "A father…", "A master…")

B. What movement does the story follow?
(Sequence of events — no allegorizing beyond this movement.)

4. What Jesus Names vs. What He Leaves Unnamed

A. Elements Jesus explicitly identifies:
(Characters, actions, outcomes He names.)

B. Elements Jesus does not identify:
(Characters or symbols the text does not assign.)

Rule: Do not assign identities Jesus does not name.

5. Boundaries of the Parable

A. What belongs to this parable only?
(Keep it in its own setting — no merging separate stories.)

B. What similar parables must remain separate?
(e.g., Treasure ≠ Pearl, Dragnet ≠ Wheat & Weeds, Thief ≠ Ten Virgins ≠ Wedding Banquet)

6. The Stated Point

A. What point does Jesus make in the text itself?
(What He says at the end, or what the comparison communicates.)

B. What the parable does not say:
(Guardrail against importing meaning.)

7. Present Lesson (Only When the Parable Supplies One)

(Some parables give a present lesson; others do not.)

If Jesus gives a present lesson, record it here:

If Jesus does not give one (e.g., Lost Son, Two Debtors, Sheep & Goats), write:

Luke/Matthew/Mark gives no explanation, and the study adds none.

8. Notes & Observations

(For personal study, teaching, or discussion.)

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